



Flagship Product Decision

Lead with export-grade ube powder, then build the Vera ingredient platform around it.

Deep-dive investor deck for Marc + Chris | Prepared May 4, 2026



Decision

Powder is the flagship. VCO becomes optional merch or a later collaboration, not the core investor story.

The investable wedge is not another purple product; it is trusted ube supply in export-ready form.

Investors will care less about novelty and more about repeatable buyer demand, QA, traceability, and working capital discipline.

Flagship

Export-grade ube powder

Shelf-stable, ingredient-led, easier to sample, ship and standardize across US, EU and GCC buyers.

Second SKU

Foodservice ube base

A thicker ready-to-use powder/paste blend for cafes, bakeries, ice cream and beverages once powder demand is proven.

Do later

VCO, halaya, extracts

Useful extensions, but either too commodity-like, too regulatory-heavy, or too flavor-house-like for the flagship.

Board-level recommendation: raise against milestones for supply, processing and buyer validation. Do not sell the story on broad medical claims or a \$200M forecast until purchase orders, capacity and yields are evidenced.

Ube has moved from diaspora dessert to mainstream product-development brief.

The timing is real, but the opportunity is still early enough that a trusted origin-and-processing brand can matter.

\$455M

Estimated 2024 global ube market

Third-party market estimate; forecast to \$944M by 2035.

\$3.06M

Philippine ube exports in 2025

DTI-reported export value; still tiny versus global attention.

359

New global ube product launches

Mintel GNPD figure cited by DTI for worldwide ube launches.

2026

Major chain validation

Starbucks launched ube drinks in US and EMEA spring menus.

What this means for Vera

The gap is not awareness anymore. It is reliable, authentic, spec-driven Philippine ube that brands can formulate with repeatedly.

The bottleneck is not demand creation; it is converting fragile roots into consistent export inputs.

Current Philippine exports are small, while buyers increasingly need formats that survive shipping, labeling, testing and formulation.

Estimated global ube market, 2024



Directional market sizing from TMR.

Philippine ube exports, 2025



DTI preliminary export value for ube and ube-based products.

13,535 MT

Philippine ube production reported for 2022

A small crop base makes farmgate contracts, planting material, post-harvest loss control and grade standards part of the product, not back-office work.

- Powder turns perishability into shelf life and sampleability.
- A grade system can separate culinary, beverage and premium Kinampay lots.
- Traceability is a commercial feature because buyers fear fake or diluted “ube.”

A weighted product screen puts powder clearly ahead of VCO, halaya and extract.

Scores reflect export readiness, demand fit, regulatory friction, brand differentiation, margin leverage and supply feasibility.



Why VCO scores low: coconut oil is already a large, competitive Philippine export category; ube color compounds are not naturally oil-friendly; and a wellness/beauty story would add claim risk without solving the ube supply problem.

Powder is the only flagship that gives Vera both low-friction export and a platform for future SKUs.

It can sell B2B first, validate demand, then feed retail, foodservice and high-value derivatives.



Flagship definition

- A product buyers reorder.
- A format regulators understand.
- A SKU that proves Vera's supply model.
- A base for future consumer products.

Launch a clean ingredient product, not a novelty powder.

The product has to read like something a QA manager, chef and importer can all approve.



Identity	Dioscorea alata; variety and farm-lot recorded
Format	Fine powder; 1 kg samples, 5 kg/25 kg B2B bags
Proof	COA: moisture, micro, heavy metals, pesticide screen
Grades	Ani culinary, Kinampay Reserve, beverage-ready blend
Claims	Flavor/color/traceability first; avoid disease claims

The first customers should be ingredient buyers, not supermarket shoppers.

Powder lets Vera create repeat demand before taking on the cost of retail distribution.

United States	Filipino distributors, specialty cafes, ice cream, bakeries	FSVP-ready importer pack; samples and COAs
Europe / UK	Specialty dessert makers, cafes, natural-color formulators	EU/UK labeling, traceability, allergen discipline
Middle East	Hotels, cafes, dessert chains, Filipino retail channels	Halal certification and Arabic label path

Initial sales motion: paid sample kits → formulation support → recurring B2B contract → co-developed retail or foodservice base.

Powder has a cleaner compliance path than shelf-stable halaya or wellness VCO.

The deck should frame compliance as a moat: buyers pay for fewer surprises.

US

- Foreign food facility registration
- Prior Notice for imported food
- US importer FSVP verification
- APHIS generally allows dried/processed plant foods without permit, subject to inspection

EU / UK

- Food hygiene and official import controls
- One-step-back / one-step-forward traceability
- Mandatory prepacked food labeling
- Check non-animal-origin risk lists before shipment

GCC / ME

- Halal certification path
- Arabic label / importer registration
- Shelf-life and storage specs
- Distributor-led market registration

Halaya warning: shelf-stable jarred products can trigger acidified/low-acid canned-food process filings in the US depending on pH, water activity and package.

Vera's moat is a farmer-linked processing system, not a standalone factory.

Every lot should connect origin, quality, yield and buyer feedback.



Investor insight

If Vera can prove consistent color, flavor and safety across farm lots, the company can sell trust and formulation reliability, not just powdered yam.

Replace the hockey-stick forecast with a staged proof of margin.

A credible investor deck should show what must be true before revenue scale is claimed.

Pilot

Paid samples + small B2B bags

Prove yield, COA, shelf-life and buyer feedback

Repeat

Recurring foodservice / ingredient orders

Prove reorder rate, gross margin and working-capital cycle

Platform

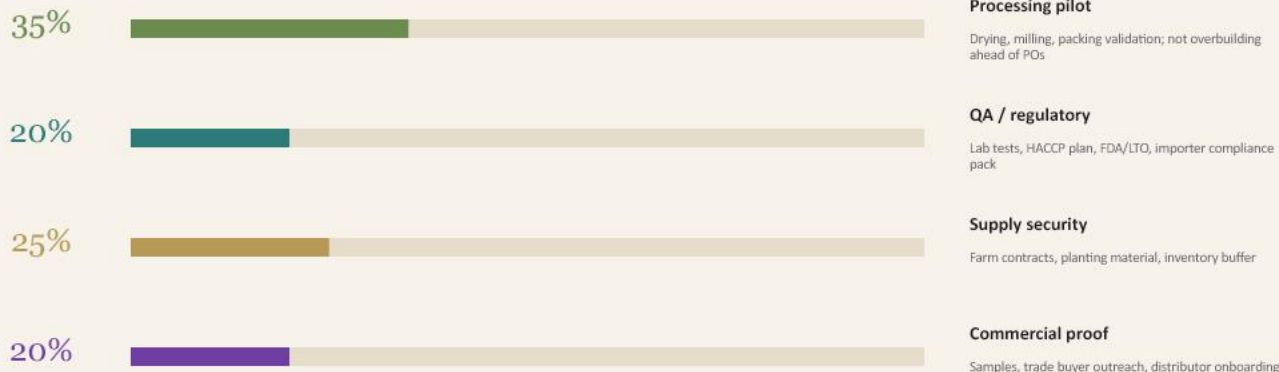
Powder + base + select retail

Expand only after powder has stable supply and demand

- Fresh kg per powder kg
- All-in processing cost / kg
- Target wholesale price / kg
- Gross margin after freight + QA
- Cash conversion cycle

The P10M pre-seed story should fund proof, not a fully scaled factory narrative.

Keep the existing raise concept, but reframe it around de-risking milestones investors can underwrite.



Deck fix: move valuation terms after the proof plan. Lead with milestones, not ownership math.

Milestones should move Vera from idea to investable export platform.

This sequence gives investors concrete gates before asking them to believe a global scale story.



Next financing trigger

Raise the next round only after repeat orders, verified gross margin, and enough contracted farm supply to support the next capacity step.

The current deck has the right heart; the revised deck needs sharper investor discipline.

Keep the farmer mission and authenticity. Remove what causes diligence drag.

Keep

- Global demand and Philippine origin are compelling.
- Farmer upside and supply security belong in the core story.
- Traceability and quality can be a real differentiator.

Change

- De-emphasize medical/superfood claims.
- Stop leading with VCO; make it a future extension.
- Replace unsupported forecast jumps with staged scenarios.
- Add buyer personas, compliance pathway and data-room checklist.

The next version should come with a short data room that proves Vera can execute.

These are the questions serious investors and B2B buyers will ask first.

Supply

Farm list, hectares, varieties, seasonality, committed kg, floor-price model

Product

Spec sheet, COA, shelf-life, packaging, moisture and micro targets

Economics

Fresh-to-powder yield, processing cost, landed cost, target wholesale price

Commercial

Buyer conversations, paid samples, LOIs, distributor terms

Regulatory

FDA/LTO, HACCP plan, FSVP pack, EU/GCC label templates

Impact

Farmer income baseline, premium paid, cooperative/community fund rules

Research Notes

Use these as the source spine for a diligence-ready investor deck. Detailed quotations should be refreshed before investor circulation.

- DTI via BusinessMirror, Feb 23 2026: \$3.06M 2025 ube exports; key markets US, UK, Italy, Middle East; 359 GNPD launches.
- DTI Quirino, May 24 2024: JaBes ube powder made third Japan shipment; export-ready work included packaging, labeling, certification and sensory/process review.
- Transparency Market Research: global ube market estimate \$455.3M in 2024, forecast \$943.6M by 2035; processed formats more attractive to industrial users.
- Starbucks Stories US/EMEA, Mar 2026: ube coconut macchiato and EMEA Ube Vanilla range indicate mainstream beverage validation.
- FDA: imported human foods require prior notice; foreign food facility registration; FSVP verification by importers; no pre-approval of products/labels.
- USDA APHIS: dried/cooked/processed fruits and vegetables are generally admissible without APHIS permit or phytosanitary certificate, subject to inspection.
- FDA LACF/AF: shelf-stable acidified/low-acid foods in hermetically sealed containers require establishment registration and scheduled processes.
- European Commission / Your Europe: EU import controls, traceability, mandatory prepacked food labeling and food safety obligations.
- Grand View Research: VCO is a large existing market; anthocyanin food colors are a separate natural-color opportunity.
- Purple-yam anthocyanin research: anthocyanins drive color but have lipophilic-system solubility/stability constraints, weakening an ube-oil flagship story.